INTAKE-ARBITER -- FREE-COOLING DECISION REPORT

Data centres over-cool, continuously, because nobody can promise them the hours ahead. A chiller plant needs hours of notice to change mode, and a thermometer only ever reports NOW -- so the mechanical chillers keep running through hours that outside air could have cooled for free. FortyGuard closes that gap with heat intelligence 2 m above the ground, the height a ground-mounted condenser actually breathes. This agent turns that forecast into an hour-by-hour schedule carrying a calibrated safety bound.

THE SITE

Location	Equinix DC97, VA -- station KIAD, America/New_York
Building	OSM 221897579 Equinix DC97
Facade gap	not applicable -- one building, no second facade
Weather record	43,763 real hourly records from KIAD
Plume physics	NOT MODELLED. No other tagged data centre lies inside the solver's validated range, so there is no neighbour intake for a plume to arrive at: the quantity does not exist here rather than being unmeasured. This is a statement about the model's domain, not a claim that recirculation here is zero. A building's own exhaust re-entering its own intake is not modelled at any site in this project.

FortyGuard data: weather and geometry are this site's own; the four measured FortyGuard level offsets and the N-26 coverage record are Ashburn's, because only Ashburn has forecast/outcome day pairs. Quote the hours for this site; quote the coverage for Ashburn.

THIS REPORT IS A SNAPSHOT, NOT THE LIVE PAGE

The interface recomputes the decision for whatever configuration a reader selects. This file was generated at build time for the ONE configuration named below, chosen because it is the configuration in which this site's agent does the most while still changing mode at least once. If the numbers on screen differ from the numbers here, the configuration differs -- compare the two lists before concluding anything else.

Day	2025-03-11 (crossing)
Plant limit	18.0 C
Notice required	3 h
Forecast skill	0.50 relative to persistence
Level anchor	sensor
Condenser bank	longest facade
Switch budget	1 mode changes per day
Minimum dwell	3 h
Max dew point	15.0 C (Green Grid WP#46 p.6)

WHAT THE AGENT DID ON THIS DAY

The agent ran free cooling for 2 of 24 hours with 1 mode change. The reactive incumbent took 13 hours -- 11 more -- but declared 1 unsafe hour against the agent's 0. The incumbent had to break its own switch budget 1 time to stay safe; the agent never did. 12 hours were safe but still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them.

Agent	2 of 24 hours free cooling, 1 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
Incumbent	13 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 1 unsafe hour(s) the incumbent broke its own switch budget 1 time(s) to stay safe 12 hour(s) passed every gate and still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them

EVERY HOUR, AND THE REASON FOR IT

hh	mode	safe	binding	bound	limit	actual	margin
00	mechanical	yes	switch budget	3.890	18.0	3.890	0.856

01	mechanical	yes	switch budget	3.890	18.0	3.890	0.796
02	mechanical	yes	switch budget	3.610	18.0	2.780	0.965
03	mechanical	yes	switch budget	2.780	18.0	1.110	0.880
04	mechanical	yes	switch budget	2.505	18.0	0.560	0.795
05	mechanical	yes	switch budget	1.920	18.0	0.000	0.971
06	mechanical	yes	switch budget	0.560	18.0	-1.110	0.785
07	mechanical	yes	switch budget	2.225	18.0	0.000	1.439
08	mechanical	yes	switch budget	6.115	18.0	5.560	1.796
09	mechanical	yes	switch budget	9.445	18.0	11.110	2.161
10	mechanical	yes	switch budget	11.390	18.0	13.890	2.067
11	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.280	18.0	17.780	1.604
12	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.055	18.0	19.440	1.173
13	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	19.725	18.0	21.110	0.993
14	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.670	18.0	21.670	1.096
15	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.500	18.0	22.780	0.942
16	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.780	18.0	22.780	0.953
17	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.500	18.0	22.220	1.223
18	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.945	18.0	21.110	1.136
19	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	20.560	18.0	18.890	1.225
20	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	19.725	18.0	17.780	1.367
21	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.335	18.0	15.560	1.527
22	FREE	yes	-	15.555	18.0	12.220	1.189
23	FREE	yes	-	15.555	18.0	13.330	0.953

bound = the agent's 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air, forecast plus margin
actual = what the intake temperature turned out to be, from the station record
margin = group-conditional forecast error for that hour of day, plus plume spread

THE REASONING, HOUR BY HOUR

00:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 3.890 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

01:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 3.890 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

02:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 3.610 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

03:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 2.780 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

04:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 2.505 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

05:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 1.920 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

06:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 0.560 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

07:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 2.225 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

08:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 6.115 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

09:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 9.445 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

10:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 11.390 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

11:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.280 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

12:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.055 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.055 C. It would take a limit 0.055 C higher, or a bound 0.055 C tighter, to change this hour.

13:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 19.725 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 1.725 C. It would take a limit 1.725 C higher, or a bound 1.725 C tighter, to change this hour.

14:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.670 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.670 C. It would take a limit 3.670 C higher, or a bound 3.670 C tighter, to change this hour.

15:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.500 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.500 C. It would take a limit 4.500 C higher, or a bound 4.500 C tighter, to change this hour.

16:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.780 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.780 C. It would take a limit 4.780 C higher, or a bound 4.780 C tighter, to change this hour.

17:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.500 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.500 C. It would take a limit 4.500 C higher, or a bound 4.500 C tighter, to change this hour.

18:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.945 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.945 C. It would take a limit 3.945 C higher, or a bound 3.945 C tighter, to change this hour.

19:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 20.560 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 2.560 C. It would take a limit 2.560 C higher, or a bound 2.560 C tighter, to change this hour.

20:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 19.725 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 1.725 C. It would take a limit 1.725 C higher, or a bound 1.725 C tighter, to change this hour.

21:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.335 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.335 C. It would take a limit 0.335 C higher, or a bound 0.335 C tighter, to change this hour.

22:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 15.555 C, which is 2.445 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.189 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.189 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

23:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 15.555 C, which is 2.445 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.953 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.953 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

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